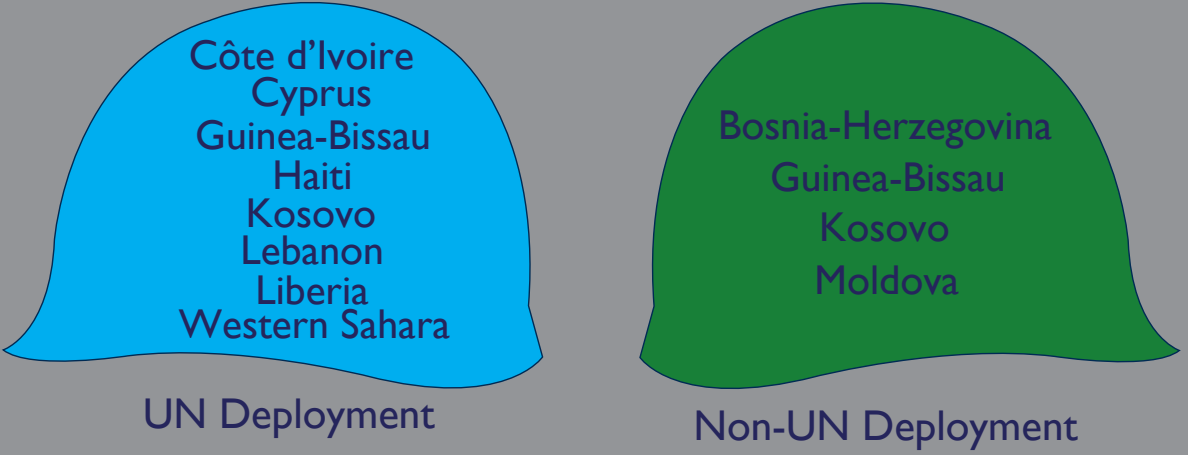


PEACEKEEPING/OBSERVER/
ENFORCEMENT MISSIONS IN 2016

At the end of 2016, Africa once again led in contributions to UN peacekeeping missions with 49,164 military, police, and observer deployments. By contrast, North America provided 198.

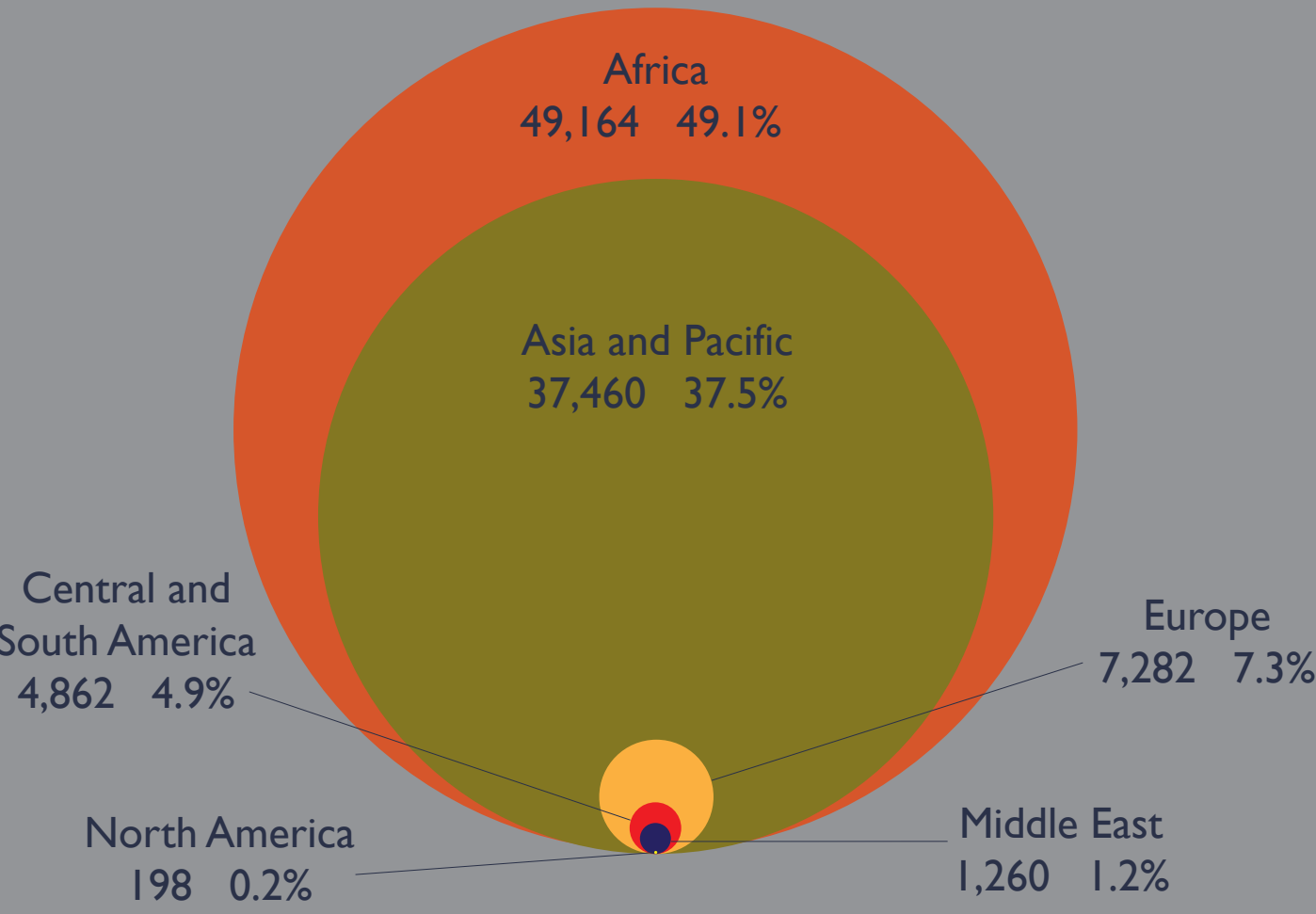
Source: United Nations Missions Summary of Military and Police 2016.

MISSIONS IN COUNTRIES
NOT HOSTING ARMED CONFLICT



Source: IISS, *The Military Balance 2016*, United Nations

Troop Contributions to UN Missions



Numbers may not add up due to rounding.

Source: United Nations Missions Summary of Military and Police 2016

SUMMARY

In 2016, 28 armed conflicts were waged in 26 countries. No new conflicts were added; and one conflict was dropped. The conflict between the Communist Party of the Philippines (CPP) and the Philippines was removed as each of the preceding two years produced fewer than 25 deaths. However, the conflict between Muslim separatist groups in the Mindanao islands region of the Philippines persisted, with more than 500 deaths in 2016.

The regional distribution of armed conflict was basically the same for the last two years. Africa and Asia continued to have the most conflicts (12 and 8, respectively), with India still hosting three separate, internal conflicts. The Middle East continued to host five armed conflicts, while Europe and the Americas had the fewest conflicts (two and one, respectively).

Syria continued to be the bloodiest conflict and remained the world's top source country for refugees. By mid-2016, 4.8-million Syrians had fled the country as refugees and more than 6.1-million people were internally displaced. By the end of the year, the total death toll had risen to more than 400,000.

In fall 2016, a historic peace deal was negotiated to end the civil war in Colombia—the only remaining conflict of its kind in the Western hemisphere. After 52 years of conflict, the Revolutionary Armed Forces of Colombia (FARC) reached a comprehensive peace agreement with the Government of Colombia in which they promised to abandon armed struggle and become a legal political party. In an October referendum, Colombian citizens rejected the proposed peace accord by less than half a percentage point, but the two parties signed a revised deal on November 24 that Congress approved on November 30.

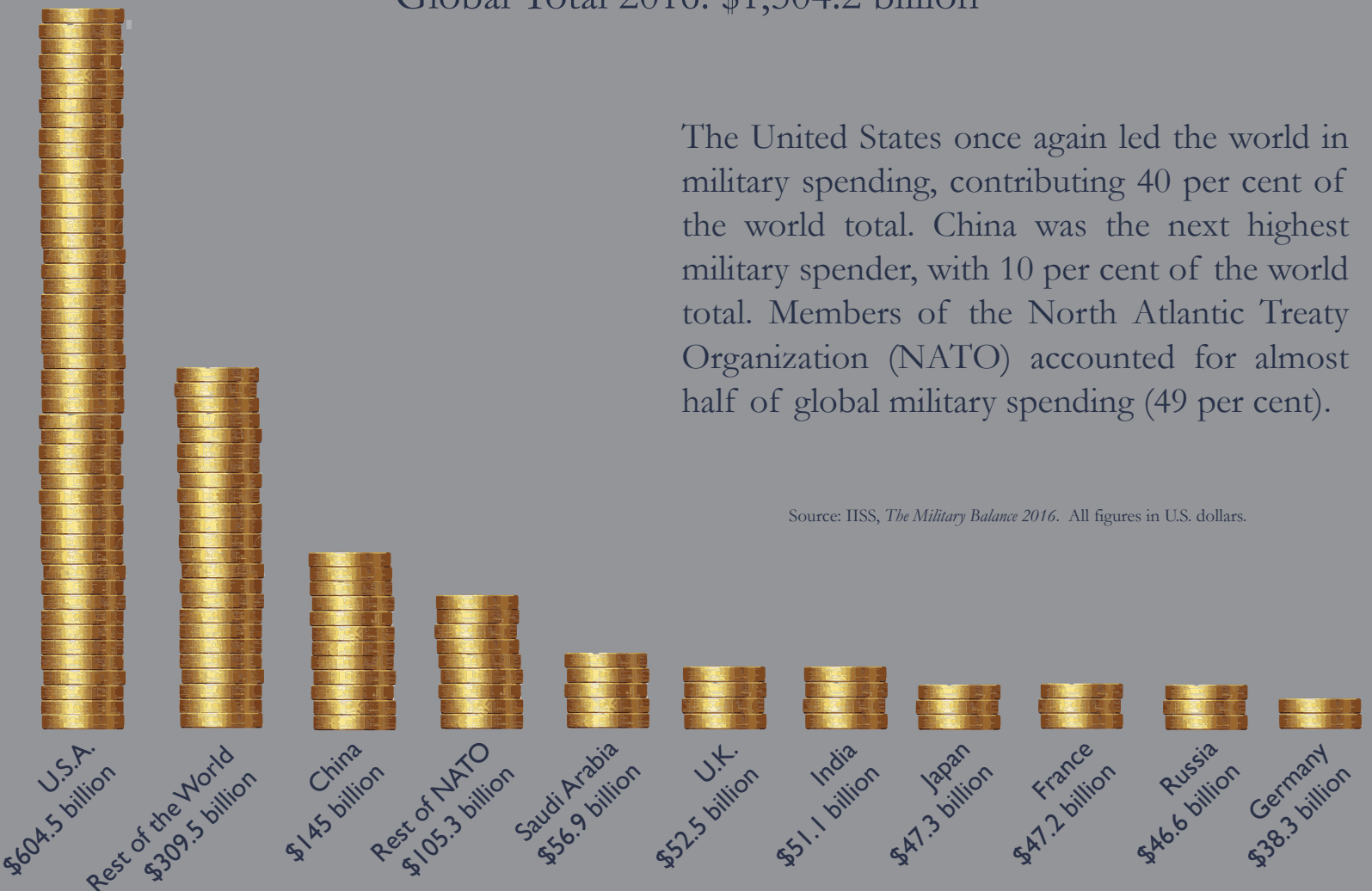
For the purposes of the *Armed Conflicts Report* an armed conflict is defined as a political conflict in which armed combat involves the armed forces of at least one state (or one or more armed factions seeking to gain control of all or part of the state), and in which at least 1,000 people have been killed by the fighting during the course of the conflict. An armed conflict is added to the annual list of current armed conflicts in the year in which the death toll reaches 1,000. An armed conflict is deemed to have ended if there has been a formal ceasefire or peace agreement and, following which, there are no longer combat deaths (or at least fewer than 25 per year); or, in the absence of a formal ceasefire, a conflict is deemed to have ended after two years of dormancy (in which fewer than 25 combat deaths per year have occurred).

SEVEREST CONFLICTS IN 2016

In eight of the 28 armed conflicts in 2016, fatalities resulting directly from armed violence exceeded 2,870. Syria was once again the bloodiest conflict by far with 49,742 deaths. According to unofficial United Nations figures, total fatalities in Syria—since the conflict began in 2011—have exceeded 400,000.

WORLD MILITARY SPENDING

Global Total 2016: \$1,504.2 billion



Source: IISS, *The Military Balance 2016*. All figures in U.S. dollars.

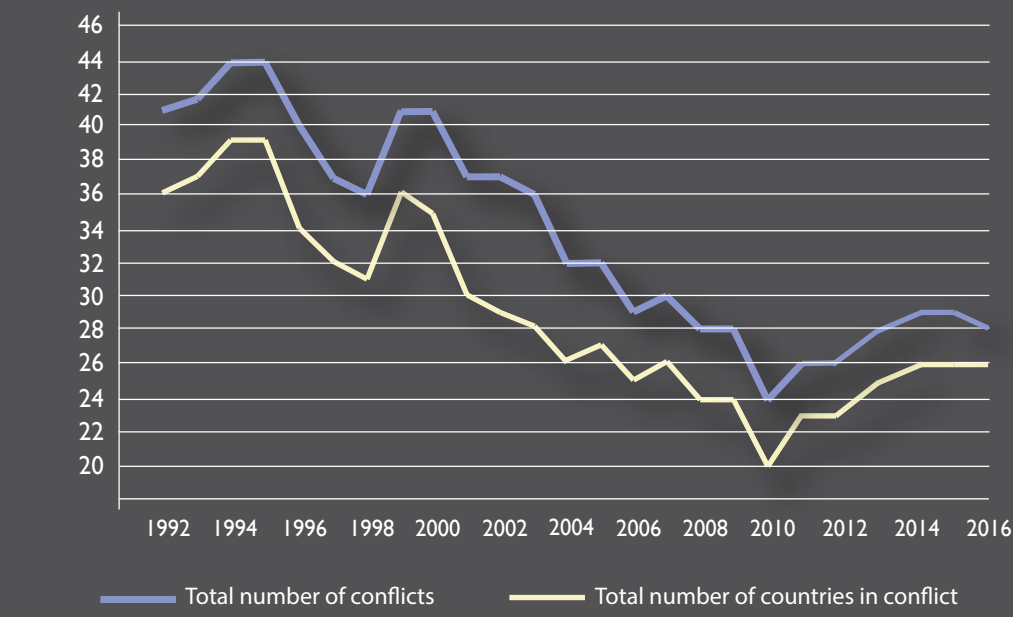
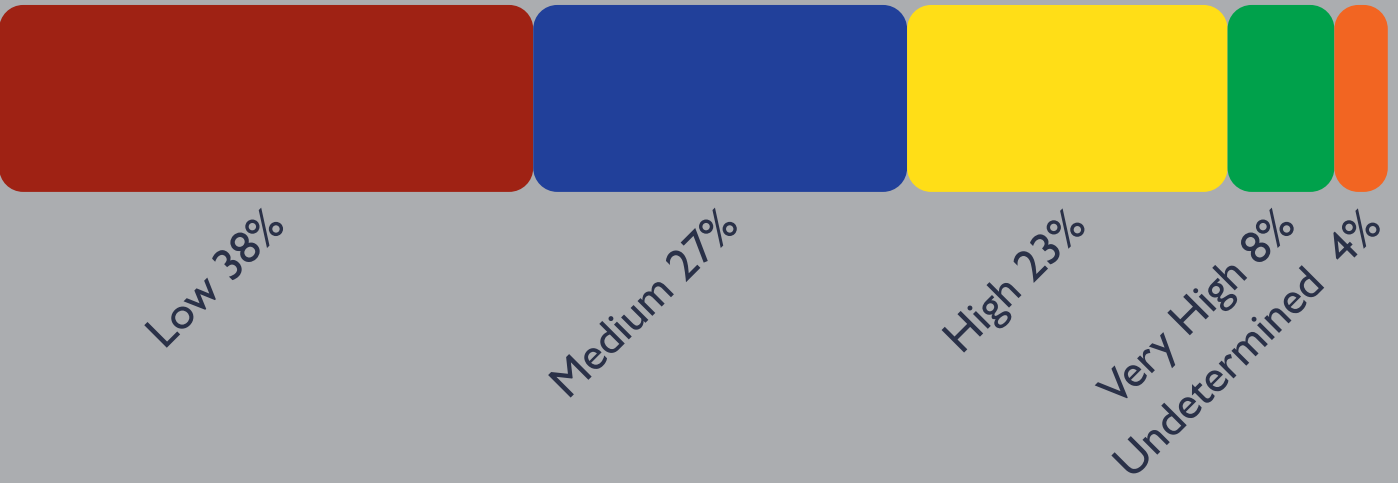
The United States once again led the world in military spending, contributing 40 per cent of the world total. China was the next highest military spender, with 10 per cent of the world total. Members of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) accounted for almost half of global military spending (49 per cent).

HUMAN DEVELOPMENT
AND ARMED CONFLICT

The *Human Development Report 2016* ranks 188 countries as Very High, High, Medium, and Low on their Human Development Index (HDI). Countries with low levels of human development are much more likely to be affected by armed conflict. Of the 26 countries that reported active armed conflict in 2016, 38 per cent ranked Low on the Human Development Index, 27 per cent ranked High, 23 per cent ranked Medium, and two countries ranked Very High (Israel and Russia).

Sources: 2016 Human Development Report

Percentage of Countries by HDI Ranking Hosting Armed Conflict



GEOGRAPHIC DISTRIBUTION OF ARMED CONFLICTS IN 2016					
Region	Number of countries in region	Number of conflicts in region	Number of countries hosting conflicts	Per cent of countries in region hosting conflict	Per cent of world conflict
AFRICA	51	12	12	24	41
ASIA	42	8	6	14	31
EUROPE	42	2	2	5	7
THE AMERICAS	44	1	1	2	4
MIDDLE EAST	14	5	5	36	17
WORLD TOTALS	193	28	26	13	100

COUNTRIES HOSTING ARMED CONFLICTS IN 2016

Civilian and military deaths during current phase of conflict(s)

- 1,000 – 10,000
- 10,000 – 100,000
- Over 100,000

Peacekeeping/Observer/Enforcement Missions in 2016

- United Nations Missions
- Non-UN Missions
- Countries hosting multiple conflicts in 2016

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SUPPORT

- Prohibit the use, possession, and manufacture of nuclear weapons;
 - Prevent the weaponization of outer space;
 - Control the supply and reduce the demand for weapons;
 - Reduce the resort to military force; and
 - Build sustainable peace in conflict zones.
- Project Ploughshares undertakes research, policy development, and public engagement to:
- Working with churches, governments, and civil society, in Canada and abroad,

PROGRAM

Isaiah 2:4 – and they shall beat their swords into ploughshares, and spears into pruning hooks; nation shall not lift up sword against nation; neither shall they learn war anymore.

Founded in 1976, Project Ploughshares is an operating division of The Canadian Council of Churches, with a mandate to advance policies and actions to prevent war and armed violence and build peace.

VISION AND MANDATE

A secure world without war, a just world at peace.

about
PROJECT PLOUGHSHARES
Research and Action for Peace

PROJECT PLOUGHSHARES ARMED CONFLICTS REPORT 2017

Project Ploughshares has reported annually on armed conflicts since 1987.

Please visit
www.ploughshares.ca

for more information on armed conflicts, including:

Interactive map of current armed conflicts,

Detailed descriptions of all current armed conflicts,

Maps and charts providing additional information
on armed conflict issues and trends.

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